

22 September 2026

Professor Sujian Guo
Editor-in-Chief
Chinese Political Science Review

Dear Professor Guo,

I am pleased to submit “The Foreign Policy Impact of Trade-Based Status Gains: When China Overtakes the US as Top Export Destination” for consideration as an Original Research Article in *Chinese Political Science Review*.

The manuscript explains when a continuous change in trade exposure becomes a politically usable status cue. It develops a formal mechanism linking public recognition of trade rank to political attention and then evaluates the argument with synthetic difference-in-differences evidence from Brazil, resolution-level United Nations voting, media and official-discourse evidence, and a cross-country interactive fixed-effects analysis.

The paper is a strong fit for the journal’s generalist mission because it connects international political economy, status, foreign-policy decision making, and causal inference. China is the central empirical case, but the contribution speaks to a broader political-science question: how publicly legible rank changes alter the recognition practices and diplomatic choices of third countries.

An earlier version was posted as a preprint on SocArXiv (https://doi.org/10.31235/osf.io/25zgv_v1). Springer Nature’s preprint policy states that posting a preprint does not constitute prior publication. The submitted manuscript has been substantially revised in theory, design, diagnostics, and scope.

The manuscript is not under consideration elsewhere. I am the sole author and approve this submission. The files include a double-anonymized manuscript, a separate title page, and supporting information prepared in both full and condensed forms. An anonymized replication archive can be supplied during peer review.

Thank you for considering the manuscript.

Sincerely,

Manoel Galdino
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